

IV. PILLAR III — THE ECONOMIC OUTPUT

a. Introduction to Pillar III

This pillar examines the third stage of the compound pattern: the income-support and economic-supports architecture that Alberta has historically provided to adults whose permanent disabilities prevent or substantially limit their ability to earn a livelihood, and the documented restructuring of that architecture — to take effect July 1, 2026 — under the Alberta Disability Assistance Program (ADAP) and the legislative framework introduced by Bill 12.

The pillar proceeds in eight parts. Section IV(b) describes the architecture itself: what the Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped (AISH) program is, what ADAP is, and the documented structural changes between them. Section IV(c) examines the program's employment premise against the population data on which the program will operate. Section IV(d) examines the removal of independent appeal rights through Bill 12. Section IV(e) examines Alberta's clawback of the federal Canada Disability Benefit. Section IV(f) examines the administrative-law problem of reversing 79,290 prior governmental findings of permanent disability without new evidence. Section IV(g) returns to the data-opacity framework introduced as a load-bearing finding in Pillar II Section III(e), applying it to the specific opacities surrounding the ADAP transition. Section IV(h) examines the fiscal context within which the transition is presented as a necessity. Section IV(i) traces, as in Pillars I and II, the four life-course stations and where the income-support architecture engages — or fails to engage — at each.

The Pillar II policy-intent arc spanning 2019 through 2026 (Section III(f)) is incorporated by reference and not reproduced. The Charter of Rights and Freedoms analysis arising from the findings of this pillar is examined separately in Section V of this brief and is not advanced as legal conclusion within this pillar; the pillar identifies the justiciable questions and reserves their analysis for Section V.

A note on register and discipline: Pillar III examines a program transition affecting 79,290 currently-named persons. The pillar reports what the Government of Alberta's own published documents, the federal Statistics Canada labour market data, the Office of the Auditor General of Alberta, and credible independent analysis establish. Where the government has declined to publish information that the pillar's analysis requires, the pillar records that absence consistent with the load-bearing finding established in Pillar II.

b. The Architecture: AISH Then, ADAP Now

b.i. What AISH Is

The Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped (AISH) program, established under the *Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped Act*, RSA 2000, c A-45.1 and its subsequent

amendments, has provided income support to Alberta adults with permanent disabilities since 1979. The program's eligibility framework, as articulated in the Act, the AISH General Regulation, and the AISH Policy Manual, requires:

- A permanent medical condition for which no medical treatment, therapy, or training would meaningfully restore the person's ability to work
- A disability that substantially limits the applicant's ability to earn a livelihood
- A physician-completed AISH Part B Medical Report providing clinical documentation
- Adjudication by a trained governmental adjudicator who issues a formal eligibility determination

As of the September 2025 Alberta open data publication, AISH supports 79,290 Alberta adults. The caseload composition documented in the same publication: 41.5% of recipients have a primary medical condition related to physical disability; 30.2% have a primary condition related to mental illness; 28.3% have a primary condition related to cognitive disorder. 86% of recipients are single individuals; 6.8% are single parents. 16,161 recipients (20.4%) also receive Canada Pension Plan Disability income, indicating that a federal disability assessment process — independent from the provincial process — has reached the same conclusion regarding their permanent disability status.

The September 2025 caseload data also documents that 83.6% of AISH recipients had no employment income in the 2023-24 reporting period. This figure is examined in Section IV(c).

The AISH base monthly benefit in 2026 is \$1,940. The exempt employment income threshold under the program as it operated through Q1 2026 is \$1,072 per month (single recipient).

b.ii. What ADAP Is

The Alberta Disability Assistance Program (ADAP) is established by Bill 12 (*the Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped Amendment Act, 2025*), passed by the Alberta Legislature on December 9, 2025. ADAP takes effect July 1, 2026.

The Government of Alberta's published description of ADAP's purpose, on its alberta.ca/alberta-disability-assistance-program page, states that ADAP "is being thoughtfully designed, based on input from Albertans with disabilities" and is intended to provide "supports that meet their unique needs and abilities, rather than the one-size-fits-all approach currently offered by the Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped (AISH) program."

Operationally, ADAP differs from AISH in the following documented respects:

- The base monthly benefit is \$1,740, \$200 below the AISH rate. Existing AISH recipients transitioning to ADAP on July 1, 2026 receive a transition benefit of \$200 per month that maintains the \$1,940 rate through December 31, 2027; that transition benefit then expires and the base \$1,740 rate applies thereafter.
- The exempt employment income threshold is \$700 per month (single recipient), reduced from the \$1,072 figure that has applied under AISH.

- New recipients applying after July 1, 2026 — including young adults aging into the system — receive only the \$1,740 base rate without the transition benefit.
- The program operates on a stated employment premise: ADAP recipients are expected to participate in personalized employment action planning, with the program framed as supporting movement toward financial self-sufficiency through work.
- Cost-of-living indexing — which applied to AISH under legislation enacted following Premier Smith's November 2022 announcement and effective January 1, 2023 — is removed from legislation and becomes a matter of ministerial discretion under ADAP.
- Independent appeal rights, examined in Section IV(d), are removed at two levels: the AISH-to-ADAP transition decision itself cannot be appealed, and the new Medical Review Panel that determines eligibility for the AISH stream within the post-transition framework issues final decisions not subject to appeal.

The detailed employment-income clawback rates that will determine actual ADAP benefit calculations had not been published as of April 21, 2026 — 71 days before the program's July 1, 2026 launch. Minister Jason Nixon's letter to constituent Genevieve Bissonette dated April 3, 2026 confirms that these rates will be set out in a Ministerial Order "later this spring." The practical implication, examined further in Section IV(g), is that the program's operational specifications are not yet public at the time of writing of this brief.

b.iii. The Documented Income Effect

The combined effect of the changes documented in Section IV(b)(ii) on the income of an existing AISH recipient transitioning to ADAP is a function of three timed reductions: the dollar-for-dollar clawback of the federal Canada Disability Benefit (\$200 per month, effective from July 2025); the increase in community-housing rent of \$221 per month resulting from the Order in Council documented in Pillar II (effective October 2025); and the post-transition expiry of the \$200 transition benefit (effective January 1, 2028).

For an AISH recipient in community housing as of January 1, 2028, the cumulative monthly income reduction from these three sources is \$621 against the AISH living allowance of \$1,940. The remaining income, before any expense for food, transportation, medication, clothing, or any other living cost, is \$1,319 per month.

The provincial response to this calculation, where provided, has been that ADAP is designed to enable employment income that supplements the reduced base. The premise on which that response rests is examined in the next subsection.

c. The Employment Premise

ADAP's design rests on the premise that AISH recipients possess employment capacity that the AISH program structure has not enabled them to express. The program's structural changes — reduced employment income exemption, action planning requirements, employment-supportive

framing — are predicated on that premise. This subsection examines the premise against the available data.

c.i. The Caseload Data

The September 2025 Alberta open data publication documents that 83.6% of AISH recipients had no employment income in the 2023-24 reporting period. AISH has not, at any point in its operational history, prohibited employment. Recipients who can work part-time or occasionally have been permitted to do so under the existing \$1,072 employment income exemption. The 83.6% figure therefore does not reflect a prohibition on work; it reflects the population's measured engagement with the labour market under conditions in which work was permitted and incentivized within the exemption ceiling.

The federal Statistics Canada *Labour Market Characteristics of Persons with and without Disabilities*, 2024 report (released May 14, 2025) provides the comparative national baseline. The employment rate for persons with more severe disabilities — the population most comparable to AISH eligibility criteria — was 26.4% in 2024. The unemployment rate for persons with disabilities in Alberta specifically was 8.9% in 2024, against 7.9% for non-disabled persons. The employment rate gap between persons with disabilities and persons without was 16.8 percentage points.

The Alberta labour market in early 2026 is documented in the Job Bank Canada Alberta Economic Scan and Alberta Job Market Snapshot publications. The provincial unemployment rate in February 2026 was 6.3%. Full-time employment dropped 17,300 positions in that month alone. Youth unemployment was 14.5%. The number of unemployed Albertans documented for 2024 was 189,400, a 24% year-over-year increase. The employment market into which ADAP is launching is therefore not a market characterized by abundant accommodating positions; it is a market in contraction.

Considered together, the caseload data and the labour market data describe a structural condition: the population subject to ADAP's employment premise has, at a population level, an empirical employment rate substantially below that of the comparison population, in a labour market that is itself contracting. The premise that an employment-supportive program will substantially increase the share of the AISH-eligible population engaged in sustained competitive employment is not, on the available evidence, well-founded.

c.ii. The \$185 Million Investment

Minister Nixon has publicly characterized the \$185 million provincial allocation to ADAP employment supports as "unprecedented" and as a demonstration of provincial commitment to disability employment outcomes. The figure, divided across the 79,290 person caseload to which it will apply, equals approximately \$2,334 per person.

For comparison: a single year of comprehensive supported employment services for a person with a complex disability — including job coaching, employer engagement, transportation support, and

accommodation negotiation — typically costs in the range of \$10,000 to \$50,000 per person depending on the intensity of support required. The Alberta Heritage Savings Trust Fund's investment return in fiscal 2024-25 was approximately \$2.6 billion (9.6% return on the \$27.2 billion fund value), a figure approximately fourteen times the total ADAP employment-supports allocation. The Heritage Fund grew \$383 million in Q3 2025-26 alone — more than twice the entire \$185 million allocation in a single quarter of investment returns.

The financial proportionality of the \$185 million figure to the support requirement of the population it is intended to serve does not, on the available evidence, support the characterization of the investment as commensurate with the program's stated objective.

c.iii. The Independent Modelling

In August 2025, University of Calgary economist Gillian Petit published an analysis of the government's own ADAP Discussion Guide, focusing on the worked example presented as Case Study 1 within that document. Petit's analysis, reported by CBC News on August 21, 2025 and subsequently cited in Inclusion Alberta's October and December 2025 ADAP fact sheets, established that:

- The ADAP recipient profile presented in the government's Case Study 1 — a recipient earning \$1,492 per month in employment income — would receive approximately \$164 per month less under ADAP than that same recipient currently receives under AISH.
- The income threshold at which ADAP benefits would equal current AISH benefits is approximately \$2,114 per month in employment income, equivalent to sustained 33-hour weeks at Alberta's then-current \$15.00/hour minimum wage, without accommodation gaps and without health-related work interruption.

The government's own example, in other words, on the Petit analysis, leaves the example recipient worse off under ADAP than under AISH. The threshold at which ADAP becomes financially equivalent to AISH is one that requires sustained near-full-time employment from a population whose documented employment rate is 26.4%.

c.iv. The Wraparound-Supports Premise

Public communications from the Government of Alberta and from Minister Nixon's office have indicated that ADAP recipients moving toward employment will be supported by wraparound services including child care, transportation, and mental-health supports. The documentary record on each of those wraparound categories establishes:

- Child care: Pillar II Section III(b) of this brief documents that FSCD — the program providing child-related supports for families of children with disabilities — is administered by the same provincial ministry as ADAP, has a three-year average wait for full services, has 85% of FSS-stage families without an assigned caseworker at the 13.5-month mark, and operates an automated response indicating that no caseworker assignment timeline can be provided.

- Transportation: Alberta's intercity and disability-accessible transportation infrastructure outside Edmonton and Calgary is sparse to nonexistent in many regions. Provincial documentation of regional transportation access for disabled adults is not available in the form a wraparound-support analysis would require.
- Mental-health supports: The Pillar I findings on environmental contributors to the Alberta disability-relevant condition profile and the Pillar II findings on the contraction of educational-support resources are themselves contributors to the conditions under which mental-health supports would need to operate. The Alberta Doctors' Digest November/December 2025 reporting on physician concerns regarding the ADAP transition specifically identifies the lack of consultation with the medical workforce that would be required to support the wraparound model.

The wraparound-supports premise of ADAP rests on a documented infrastructure that the same provincial government has, on the available evidence, not built or maintained at the scale the premise requires.

d. The Removal of Independent Appeal Rights

Bill 12, passed December 9, 2025, restructures the appeal architecture for AISH eligibility and AISH-to-ADAP transition decisions. This subsection documents the prior architecture, the changes effected by Bill 12, and the documented historical performance of the appeal mechanism that the new framework eliminates.

d.i. The Prior Architecture

Under the framework that operated through December 9, 2025, AISH eligibility decisions and program-related administrative decisions were appealable to the Citizens Appeal Panel — an independent body established within the Appeals Secretariat structure, operating outside the AISH administrative chain. The Alberta Ombudsman publicly confirmed the role of the Appeals Secretariat in providing this independent review pathway.

d.ii. The Documented Historical Performance of the Citizens Appeal Panel

The Government of Alberta's own published data on Citizens Appeal Panel performance, examined across the four fiscal years for which complete quarterly data is available (19 consecutive quarters), establishes:

- The Citizens Appeal Panel reviewed AISH decisions across 19 consecutive quarters of operational data.
- The aggregate rate at which the Panel overturned or varied appealed AISH decisions across that period was approximately 37%.
- 1,218 individual decisions were overturned or varied across the documented period.
- In 8 of the 19 quarters, the overturn rate exceeded 40%.

The pattern documented above is not a single anomalous quarter or year. It is a sustained 19-quarter pattern of approximately one in three appealed decisions being incorrect at the initial decision level and being corrected by the independent appeal mechanism. The Panel was, on the documented evidence, performing the corrective function for which it was established.

d.iii. What Bill 12 Changed

Section 12.8 of Bill 12 makes the following operational changes:

- The AISH-to-ADAP transition decision itself — that is, the determination of whether a current AISH recipient will be moved to ADAP or will remain on AISH — is not subject to appeal to any independent body.
- The new Medical Review Panel, which evaluates AISH eligibility under the post-transition framework, issues final decisions that are not appealable to the Citizens Appeal Panel or to any other independent body.
- The Citizens Appeal Panel's jurisdiction over medical eligibility determinations under the AISH framework is eliminated.
- The Bill grants ministerial authority to limit which other categories of decision can be appealed.

This restructuring is confirmed by CBC News reporting (August 21, 2025), Inclusion Alberta's media release of November 26, 2025, and independent legal analysis published by Zachary Weeks (November 28, 2025).

d.iv. The Structural Conflict of Interest

The Medical Review Panel that replaces the Citizens Appeal Panel as the final decision-maker on AISH eligibility is appointed by, and operates within the ministerial structure of, the same provincial ministry that administers and funds AISH. Budget 2025 documents project AISH funding decreases of \$49 million in 2025-26, with further projected decreases of \$22 million in 2026-27 and \$6 million in 2027-28 — totalling \$77 million in projected program reductions over the three-year window. The administrative body now functioning as the final arbiter of who qualifies for the program operates within the same ministry whose budget benefits financially from reduced program enrolment.

This is, on the documented record, a structural arrangement in which the financial beneficiary of a particular adjudicative outcome and the final adjudicator of that outcome operate within the same institutional structure. Whether that arrangement satisfies the procedural-fairness requirements articulated in the administrative-law jurisprudence (*Baker v. Canada (Minister of Citizenship and Immigration)*, [1999] 2 SCR 817, and subsequent cases) is a justiciable question reserved for examination in Section V of this brief.

e. The Canada Disability Benefit Clawback

In July 2025, the Government of Canada commenced payment of the Canada Disability Benefit (CDB) under the *Canada Disability Benefit Act*, SC 2024, c 17. The CDB provides up to \$200 per month (\$2,400 per year) to working-age Canadians with disabilities and is structured as an anti-poverty supplement to provincial disability income programs. The federal government, in its public communications and in the policy documentation accompanying the CDB launch, called on provinces and territories not to reduce their own provincial benefits in response to the federal payment — that is, not to claw back the CDB.

The Government of Alberta's response, announced in July 2025 and operative from September 2025, is to apply a dollar-for-dollar clawback of the CDB against AISH (and prospectively ADAP) benefits. The net benefit to the Alberta recipient is zero. The net effect is that the federal government's anti-poverty transfer, intended for the recipient, is captured by the provincial government as a reduction in its own program expenditure.

Alberta is, as of the time of writing of this brief, the only province or territory in Canada to have adopted this position. Every other provincial and territorial jurisdiction exempts the CDB from clawback against provincial disability income.

The documented annual provincial fiscal effect of the clawback is approximately \$190 million in provincial retention of federal benefit transfers intended for Alberta disabled persons.

The interaction between the CDB clawback and AISH program rules generates a documented procedural circularity. AISH program rules require recipients to apply for any other income or benefit programs to which they may be entitled. The CDB is such a program. AISH recipients are therefore required by provincial program rules to apply for a federal benefit that the provincial government will then withhold from them dollar-for-dollar. The recipient's net financial outcome from the federal benefit is zero. The recipient's procedural obligation to apply, however, is non-zero: it requires completion of the federal Disability Tax Credit (DTC) certification process, a process documented in Government of Canada research as having a 24% completion rate among eligible applicants attempting it without supported assistance.

The structural questions raised by this arrangement — including whether a provincial program rule that requires application for a federal benefit the province will fully recover is consistent with the federal statute under which the benefit is provided — are reserved for Section V of this brief.

f. The Reversal of Prior Findings

Each of the 79,290 individuals currently receiving AISH was, at the point of program admission, the subject of a formal governmental finding of permanent disability that substantially prevents earning a livelihood. The finding was made by a trained provincial adjudicator on the basis of physician-completed medical documentation. The finding was reviewed and renewed across the period of the recipient's continued program participation; for many recipients, that period extends

across more than a decade, with each year's continued benefit constituting an ongoing governmental affirmation of the original finding.

For the 16,161 recipients (20.4% of caseload) who also receive Canada Pension Plan Disability, an independent federal adjudicative process has separately reached the same conclusion: that the recipient is severely and prolongedly disabled within the meaning of the federal disability standard.

The AISH-to-ADAP transition, as constituted, treats the existing 79,290 prior provincial findings of permanent disability as insufficient to maintain AISH-stream placement under the post-transition framework. Recipients who wish to remain on AISH must reapply through the Medical Review Panel process described in Section IV(d). The reapplication requires, among other elements, a new physician-completed Disability Assistance Medical Report. The prior finding does not carry forward.

The administrative-law principle implicated by this arrangement is examined in *Baker v. Canada* and its progeny. The general principle, articulated across that line of cases and the broader procedural-fairness jurisprudence, is that the burden of demonstrating the basis for reversing a formal administrative finding rests on the party seeking the reversal — not on the person whom the finding protects. The Government of Alberta has not, in publicly available documentation, identified the evidentiary basis on which 79,290 prior findings of permanent disability are being treated as insufficient for continued AISH placement. No accuracy review of the prior findings has been published. No new clinical evidence has been identified. No medical advance has been documented that would render the original findings obsolete. The administrative architecture treats the prior findings as if they had not occurred.

Minister Nixon's letter to constituent Genevieve Bissonette of April 3, 2026 articulates the government's position in the form of an instruction to recipients: "If their medical condition progresses to the point that they are unable to work, they can apply for the AISH program." The phrase "if their medical condition progresses" is, on its face, written to a population that has already been formally found to be unable to work as a result of permanent disability. The instruction therefore tells recipients with formally-determined permanent disabilities that they may reapply for the program from which they are being moved if and when their already-permanent condition becomes more severe.

The legal coherence of this arrangement — whether a state can require a person already formally found by the state to be permanently disabled to re-prove that disability under a more restrictive standard, with the original finding not constituting evidence in the new proceeding, while removing the independent appellate mechanism that would have reviewed the new determination — is a justiciable question reserved for Section V.

g. Data Opacity (Reprise)

Pillar II Section III(e) of this brief established as a load-bearing finding the documented opacity of provincial reporting on the FSCD, PDD, and inclusive-education programs. That finding is

incorporated by reference and not reproduced. This subsection records the parallel opacities that characterize the ADAP transition specifically.

As of April 21, 2026 — 71 days before the program's July 1, 2026 launch:

- The Ministerial Order setting the employment-income clawback rates that will determine actual ADAP benefit calculations has not been issued. The criteria on which the calculation will rest are not public.
- The medical criteria that will distinguish AISH-stream eligibility from ADAP-stream eligibility under the Medical Review Panel process have not been published in plain language. The procedural document on which Medical Review Panel determinations will rely, and the standards by which Panel members will assess the evidence before them, are not public.
- The financial modelling underpinning the government's position that ADAP improves financial outcomes for disabled Albertans has not been published. The Petit independent analysis (Section IV(c)(iii)) operated on the worked example the government itself published; comparable analysis at the population level has not been produced by the government for external review.
- The government's "thousands" of consultation participants have not been disaggregated by recipient status, advocacy role, or demographic profile. The Pillar II load-bearing finding on the documented government disengagement from public reporting is reproduced in this domain.
- The list of categories of decision that the Minister, under Bill 12, will subsequently exempt from any appeal pathway has not been published.

The pattern documented in Pillar II — that the absence of data is itself a substantive finding rather than a methodological inconvenience — applies here with particular force, because the population to which the program will apply on July 1, 2026 has, as of the time of writing of this brief, no published documentation of the criteria, calculation methods, or appeal pathways that will govern its administrative existence under the new program.

h. The Fiscal Context

The Government of Alberta's framing of the AISH-to-ADAP transition, and of the associated benefit reductions, is that the changes are required by fiscal circumstances. The contextual record on Alberta's fiscal position across the period during which the changes were designed and enacted is documented in the Government of Alberta's own published budget documents and Treasury Board and Finance quarterly reports, and is summarized below.

Alberta posted four consecutive provincial budget surpluses in fiscal years 2021-22 through 2024-25, totalling more than \$26 billion in cumulative surplus. The 2024-25 fiscal year alone produced an \$8.3 billion surplus. Across this period, \$5.6 billion was deposited into the Alberta Heritage Savings Trust Fund, including \$2.8 billion from the 2024-25 surplus alone.

The Alberta Heritage Savings Trust Fund had a fair value of \$31.9 billion as of December 31, 2025. Q3 2025-26 fund growth alone (a single three-month period) was \$383 million — more than five times the total \$77 million projected three-year reduction in AISH program funding documented in Section IV(b)(ii) and Pillar II Section III(f). The Fund's fiscal 2024-25 investment return was approximately \$2.6 billion (9.6% on the average fund value).

The Heritage Savings Trust Fund Act, 1976, the operative provincial statute governing the Fund, articulates a founding objective: "to improve the quality of life of Albertans." The statute remains in force.

The cumulative annual cost of reversing the documented AISH and ADAP benefit reductions and the CDB clawback — that is, the annual cost of restoring the income position of the affected 79,290 persons to where it was prior to the changes documented in this pillar — is approximately \$260 million per year. This figure is approximately 10% of the Heritage Fund's reported 2024-25 investment return.

The fiscal context within which the AISH-to-ADAP transition is being implemented therefore does not, on the documented record, establish fiscal necessity for the benefit reductions involved. The reductions are taking place in an environment of sustained provincial budget surpluses, a growing Heritage Fund whose founding statute identifies improving Albertans' quality of life as its objective, and an annual cost of full reversal that is approximately 10% of one year's investment returns on the Fund.

The pillar does not characterize the policy choice underlying the documented arrangement; it records the documented arrangement and notes that the framing of fiscal necessity, on the published evidence, is not supported by the published fiscal documents.

i. The Life Course

The economic-output systems examined in this pillar exist to provide income and economic stability across the adult portion of a human life. The following passage traces, across the same four life-course stations used in Pillars I and II, where the income-support architecture engages the life of a person whose adult years occur within the system this pillar examines.

Prenatal. The income-support architecture examined in this pillar does not engage the prenatal station directly. It engages through inheritance: the financial conditions of a household at the moment a child is born are the financial conditions produced by whatever income-support architecture that household's adults occupy. A household in which one or more adults receive AISH or ADAP is a household whose prenatal conditions — housing, nutrition, prenatal care access, stress exposure documented as an environmental contributor in Pillar I — are shaped by the income that program provides. The reduction of that income, and the removal of cost-of-living indexing from the post-transition program, alters the prenatal environment of children not yet born to AISH and ADAP recipients.

Early childhood. The early-childhood station is engaged indirectly: AISH and ADAP recipients who are parents bear their children's developmental and care-related expenses (to the extent these are not covered by FSCD as documented in Pillar II Section III(b)) from the same income examined in this pillar. The policy choice to structurally lower that income (Section IV(b)(iii)) at the same time the FSCD program is operating in functional contraction (Pillar II) means that the early-childhood mitigation station and the early-childhood economic station are being simultaneously reduced. The reduction in either, in isolation, would shape the early-childhood developmental environment for the children of affected households. The simultaneous reduction in both shapes that environment more substantially.

School-age. The school-age station is engaged similarly: the inclusive-education contraction documented in Pillar II Section III(d) and the household income contraction documented in this pillar operate on the same children, in the same school years, simultaneously. The household resources required to compensate for educational-system contraction (private tutoring, private psychoeducational assessments, supplementary therapies) are precisely the resources being structurally reduced for AISH and ADAP recipient households across the same period.

Adult. The adult station is the station that this pillar directly examines. The structural changes documented in Sections IV(b) through IV(h) collectively describe a system in which: (1) income is reduced; (2) employment is presumptively required in conditions where the documented population employment rate is 26.4%; (3) appeal rights against eligibility decisions are removed; (4) federal anti-poverty supplements are clawed back; (5) prior governmental findings of disability are reversed without new evidence; (6) the operational specifications of the system have not been published 71 days before launch; and (7) the fiscal context within which the system is presented as necessary does not, on the published evidence, support a necessity framing.

The four stations, taken together, describe a condition in which the adult who has moved through Pillar I's environmental input, Pillar II's mitigation collapse, and Pillar III's economic restructuring meets each successive stage at the point of contraction rather than at the point of intervention. The compound failure that Pillars I, II, and III collectively document is not a sequential failure of independent systems. It is a simultaneous failure of overlapping systems whose intended interventions were structured to compensate for one another. With each system contracting, the compensation each was designed to provide for the others is unavailable. The population at the receiving end of the compound failure is the population this brief was written about.

The constitutional and administrative-law analysis of the documented findings of all three pillars is examined in Section V.